in 335 BCE. It is here that Alexander studied under ***Aristotle***. The teaching and research program included every branch of knowledge. ***Aristotle*** was born in Stagira in 384 BCE. Unlike ***Plato***, ***Aristotle*** came from an upper middle class family. His father Nicomachus was the personal physician to king Amyntas of Macedon.

'***Aristotle***' whose name means 'the best purpose' stood true to his name when he proposed the 'Best Practicable State' as opposed to ***Plato***'s 'Ideal State'. According to ***Aristotle***, "the State exists for an end and this end is the supreme good of man in both moral and intellectual life".

Aristotle's Works

He wrote many books on subjects ranging from Greek literature to Zoology. But his most famous work is called 'Politics' from which modern Political Science has grown. Thus he is called as the 'father of Political Science'. Though the exact date of its publication is not known, it is a voluminous work consisting of 8 books and having more than 1000 pages. Unlike ***Plato***'s agreement with his teacher ***Socrates***, ***Aristotle*** did not agree on many things his teacher ***Plato*** had to say.

Quotable Quote

The whole is more than the Sum of its parts - ***Aristotle***

Aristotle's Thought

Almost all his political ideas are known through his book 'Politics'.

State as a Natural Institution

According to him authority of the State is moral and the State is natural. Since the family could not satisfy the ever increasing needs of the people, they had to come out of their limited circle and thought of creating the State. The families combined together to make the State and made it a perfect association. ***Aristotle*** believes that the State is an individual writ large because the individual can think of perfection only in a State.

Functions of the State

According to ***Aristotle*** the foremost function of the State is to promote good life and create essential conditions for mental, moral and physical development of the people. The State should also function in such a way that good habits of individuals are converted into good actions and promote good, happy and honourable life.

Theory of Citizenship

Aristotle did not believe that mere residence or enjoyment of legal rights or birth should confer the right of citizenship on a person. He said, "It is the function which entitles a person to become citizen". A person should participate in the popular assembly which was vested with the authority of exercising sovereign powers. A citizen should be able to partake in decision making process of the government.

Classification of States

He classifies States on quantitative as well as qualitative basis:

Quantity	Quality	
Type	**Good Form**	**Perverted Form**
One	Monarchy	Tyranny
A Few	Aristocracy	Oligarchy
Many	Polity	Democracy

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